



UNITED STATES MARINE CORPS
MARINE CORPS TACTICAL SUPPORT ACTIVITY
BOX 555171
CAMP PENDLETON, CA

IN REPLY REFER TO:
4200

Subj: **USE OF OTHER THAN FULL AND OPEN COMPETITION FOR AN ACQUISITION UNDER THE SIMPLIFIED ACQUISITION THRESHOLD**

I. BACKGROUND:

1. FAR 13.106-1(b)(1)(i) states for purchases not exceeding the simplified acquisition threshold, Contracting Officers may solicit from one source if the Contracting Officer determines that the circumstances of the contract action deem only one source reasonably available (e.g., urgency, exclusive licensing agreements, brand-name or industrial mobilization).
2. As required by FAR 13.106-3(b)(3)(i), this memorandum explains the absence of competition for this acquisition, as only one source will be solicited for this requirement (or for a portion of the requirement) and the requirement is not expected to exceed the simplified acquisition threshold.

II. DESCRIPTION OF ITEM OR SERVICE:

The Marine Corps Tactical Systems Support Activity (MCTSSA), through its Test and Engineering Division (TED) Cyber Branch, provides technical expertise, experimentation, and system testing to support Marine Corps tactical system readiness.

To address this requirement, MCTSSA requires Security Onion Solutions, LLC's "Security Onion" platform, including Security Onion Pro software, node scalability, professional services, and annual instructor-led training with certification support for eight personnel. This solution delivers a purpose-built, operationally proven capability enabling centralized log aggregation, real-time alerting, intrusion detection, and threat hunting, while ensuring compatibility with existing Marine Corps systems and cybersecurity architectures.

This capability is essential to support DCO experimentation and tactical employment by enabling the identification of adversarial activity, generation of actionable alerts, development of tactics, techniques, and procedures (TTPs), and improved cyber situational awareness through identification of indicators of compromise (IOCs). The inclusion of training and certification ensures personnel can effectively employ the platform, while node scalability and professional services ensure proper implementation and alignment with existing infrastructure.

Requested Contract Award/Delivery Date: 28 May 2026.

Technical Requirements are reflected in Table 1:

Table 1

Line	Part Number	Product	PoP	Qty
0001	SOS-SOPRO-BASE-1-1Y	Security Onion Pro License – Single Node – 1 year	28 May 2026 - 27 May 2027	2
0002	SOS-SOPRO-NDPK-5-1Y	Security Onion Pro Node Pack – Up to 5 Additional Nodes – 1 year	28 May 2026 - 27 May 2027	2
0003	SOS-SOPRO-NDPK-1-1Y	Security Onion Pro Node Pack – 1 Additional Node – 1 year	28 May 2026 - 27 May 2027	2
0004	SOS-PROFSERV-10	Professional Services – 10 hours		2

Line	Part Number	Product	PoP	Qty
0005	SOS-LIVE-FUND-08	Security Onion Fundamentals for Analysts & Admins – Instructor Led (up to 8 students)		1
0006	EXP-TRAVEL	Travel Expenses		1
0007	SOS-SOCP	Security Onion Certified Professional Exam Voucher		8

III. THE DETERMINATION FOR USE OF OTHER THAN FULL AND OPEN COMPETITION IS BASED ON THE FOLLOWING:

A. X ONLY ONE RESPONSIBLE SOURCE:

1. ___ RESTRICTIVE RIGHTS. The source has established proprietary rights, limited rights in data, patent rights, copyrights or secret processes in the item or service required.

2. X EXCLUSIVE LICENSING AGREEMENTS. The item or service is only available from the Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM), or there is only one authorized distributor or technical representative for the OEM.

The Government intends to award a sole-source contract to Security Onion Solutions, LLC for the procurement of Security Onion Pro software, associated node scalability, and instructor-led training with certification support. This determination is based on the existence of restricted rights and the proprietary nature of the required items and services.

Security Onion Solutions, LLC retains exclusive intellectual property rights to the Security Onion Pro platform, including its proprietary configurations, integrated toolsets, and commercial enhancements to the underlying open-source components. These rights encompass the software’s architecture, orchestration layers, update mechanisms, and specialized integrations that enable network security monitoring (NSM), intrusion detection, full packet capture, and threat hunting within a unified platform. Additionally, Security Onion Certified Professional (SOCP) training and associated course materials are proprietary to Security Onion Solutions, LLC and are not licensed or authorized for delivery by third parties outside of approved channels.

These restrictive rights render the required software and training available from only one responsible source. No other vendor possesses the authority to provide the Security Onion Pro platform with its full suite of capabilities, nor can any third party deliver certified SOCP training that meets the Government’s requirement for standardized, mission-aligned instruction. While resellers may exist for limited components, market research confirmed that no authorized reseller can provide the complete solution—software, licensing, training, and support—as an integrated offering. Review of SAM.gov also indicates that other DoW organizations, including the U.S. Air Force (e.g., Notice ID FA480024QA044), have procured Security Onion Certified Professional (SOCP) training via direct sole-source methods, further supporting the conclusion that the requirement is not competitively available.

Furthermore, no alternative commercial solution can satisfy the Government’s requirement without substantial modification. The Security Onion platform is purpose-built for Defensive Cyberspace Operations (DCO) and is already aligned with Marine Corps operational environments and tools used by Fleet Marine Forces. Replicating this capability with another vendor would require significant customization, integration of disparate tools, additional licensing, and extensive configuration to achieve comparable functionality. This would introduce unacceptable cost increases, schedule delays, and technical risk, while also failing to ensure interoperability with existing systems and continuity with operational DCO practices.

Accordingly, due to the proprietary rights held by Security Onion Solutions, LLC, the lack of authorized sources capable of delivering the complete requirement, and the inability of alternative solutions to meet the Government’s needs without substantial risk, Security Onion Solutions, LLC is the only responsible source. This justifies the use of a sole-source procurement in accordance with applicable Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) authorities.

3. ___ OTHER REASONS.

B. X BRAND NAME. Item required must be a brand name product, or feature of a product, particular to one manufacturer.

Pursuant to FAR 11.104, the Government has determined that a brand name specification is required for the procurement of Security Onion Solutions, LLC’s “Security Onion” platform, including Security Onion Pro software, node scalability, and Security Onion Certified Professional (SOCP) training. This determination is based on the essentiality of the platform’s unique capabilities, and the results of market research demonstrate that no other product can meet the Government’s requirements without substantial risk.

The Government is precluding consideration of products manufactured by other companies because Security Onion Solutions, LLC provides a purpose-built, tightly integrated platform specifically designed for network security monitoring (NSM), intrusion detection,

full packet capture, and threat hunting in support of Defensive Cyberspace Operations (DCO). The platform's architecture integrates multiple security tools into a unified, operationally proven environment that aligns with Marine Corps systems and mirrors capabilities used by Fleet Marine Forces. These capabilities are not merely functional requirements, but mission-critical features necessary to support experimentation, tactical development, and operational readiness.

The Security Onion platform is essential to the Government's requirements due to its unique combination of integrated capabilities, including centralized log aggregation, real-time alerting, intrusion detection, and packet-level analysis within a single, cohesive system. Additionally, the platform includes proprietary orchestration, configuration management, and update mechanisms that ensure consistent performance and interoperability across environments. The associated SOCP training is also a critical component, as it provides standardized, platform-specific instruction required to effectively employ the system in a DCO context. These features are intrinsic to the platform and cannot be replicated through a "brand name or equal" specification without fundamentally altering the requirement or introducing unacceptable risk.

A "brand name or equal" purchase description cannot be used because no other commercially available product offers an equivalent, fully integrated solution that meets all required technical and operational criteria. Attempting to define "equal" characteristics would either be overly restrictive—effectively describing only Security Onion—or too broad, resulting in solutions that lack critical capabilities or require extensive modification. In either case, the Government would incur increased costs, schedule delays, and technical risk associated with integrating multiple disparate tools to approximate the required functionality.

Market research conducted across Department of War Enterprise Software Initiative (DoW ESI), National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) Solutions for Enterprise-Wide Procurement (SEWP), and SAM.gov confirmed that while other cybersecurity and analytics platforms exist, none provide the same combination of capabilities in a unified, mission-aligned solution. No authorized reseller was identified that could deliver the complete requirement, including software, licensing, and certified training. Furthermore, similar products either lack full packet capture integration, require significant customization to achieve comparable functionality, or depend on additional third-party components and licensing structures. These limitations prevent such products from meeting the Government's needs without substantial modification, which would introduce unacceptable cost, schedule, and performance risks.

Accordingly, the specific brand name Security Onion Solutions, LLC, is essential to meet the Government's minimum requirements. The use of a brand name specification is therefore justified, as no other product can meet the requirement without compromising mission effectiveness, increasing risk, or requiring fundamental changes to the Government's operational objectives.

C. ___ UNUSUAL AND COMPELLING URGENCY. The supplies or services are of such unusual and compelling urgency that the Government would be seriously injured unless the agency is permitted to limit the number of sources from which it solicits bids or proposals. Urgent requirements are supplies or services that will result in a work stoppage or are mission critical and the routine processing time would result in injury to the Government. The determination that the procurement for the above item/service is an urgent and compelling requirement is based on the following:

1. Date on which the requirement was first identified:
2. Required delivery date/period of performance:
3. Explanation of why delivery/commencement of services by the date mentioned above is required:
4. If appropriate, include any additional pertinent information.

IV. CERTIFICATIONS/APPROVALS:

A. Technical / Requirements Certification: I certify that the facts and representation under my cognizance which are included in this justification are complete and accurate to the best of my knowledge and belief.

[Redacted Signature]

B. Certification/Approval. (See FAR 13.501)

[Redacted Signature]

[Redacted Signature]